

Alexandra Barka

SOFTWARE ENGINEER · FRONTEND ENGINEERING · WEB ACCESSIBILITY · PRODUCT BUILDER

Amsterdam, Netherlands

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Building elegant, accessible and user-focused digital products.

Profile

Creative and detail-oriented software engineer with more than ten years of experience building user-focused web products across hospitality, music, streaming, communications and human-computer interaction. Combines deep React, TypeScript and JavaScript expertise with strong product judgement, accessibility practice and an eye for UI quality. Experienced in modernising frontend platforms, improving performance and reliability, mentoring engineers and partnering closely with Product, Design, Backend and QA.

Skills

Frontend

React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Next.js, HTML5, Redux, TanStack Query, TanStack Table, GraphQL, Zod

Styling & UI

CSS3, SASS, Tailwind CSS, Flexbox, Grid, Design Systems, Storybook, Figma

Quality

Jest, Vitest, Playwright, unit testing, integration testing, end-to-end testing, code reviews, frontend observability

Backend & APIs

Node.js, REST APIs, GraphQL APIs, C, API integration

Engineering

Frontend architecture, performance, observability, Git, GitHub, GitLab, Sentry, New Relic, Coralogix

AI-assisted engineering

Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, prompt engineering, AI agents, MCP servers, reusable skills, human-in-the-loop development

Collaboration

Product engineering, cross-functional delivery, technical leadership, mentoring, agile

Experience

Mews

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Aug. 2024 – Present

- Build, maintain, and improve core events functionality, supporting quotations, event spaces, and relevant operational workflows.
- Deliver end-to-end solutions across frontend and backend services, improving reliability and maintainability for high-volume hospitality operations.
- Drive frontend improvements, including quote redesign, quote details improvements, email template redesigns, and overall UI enhancements with a focus on usability, responsiveness, and performance.
- Improve web performance, architecture and technical decisions to reduce technical debt and support long-term scalability.
- Collaborate with Product, Design, Backend, QA, and cross-functional engineering teams to deliver features supporting PMS integrations, accounting, tax workflows, and high-volume hospitality operations.
- Improve code quality through refactoring, stronger validation patterns, automated testing, and increased unit test coverage.
- Leverage AI-assisted engineering, including Claude Code, AI agents, MCPs, and prompt engineering to accelerate implementation, debugging, testing, documentation, and developer productivity while maintaining high engineering standards.

Spotify

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

WEB ENGINEER II

Sep. 2022 – Aug. 2024

- Delivered end-to-end product features, collaborating with Product Managers, Designers, Backend Engineers, Data teams, and stakeholders from discovery through production.
- Developed internal tools that enabled marketing operators to create, manage, and optimise campaigns supporting user acquisition, engagement, and retention.
- Led technical initiatives, driving projects from planning through delivery while influencing technical decisions and engineering best practices.
- Mentored junior engineers, supported intern onboarding, conducted code reviews, and encouraged knowledge sharing across the engineering organisation.
- Improved code quality through refactoring, reusable components, automated testing, and engineering best practices.
- Collaborated closely with cross-functional teams to translate evolving business requirements into high-quality product experiences.
- Contributing to subscriber growth of Spotify by supporting the marketing teams that are using our tools

WarnerMedia – HBO Max

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

FRONTEND ENGINEER

Jul. 2021 – Aug. 2022

- Built and delivered customer-facing features for HBO Max TV applications using JavaScript, TypeScript, JSX, and the Lightning TV Framework.
- Contributed to the international launch of HBO Max across Latin America and Europe, helping support millions of new subscribers and regional product rollouts.
- Migrated TV applications to a shared Design System, improving UI consistency, maintainability, scalability, and developer experience.
- Developed responsive, accessible user interfaces while contributing to organisation-wide accessibility (WCAG) initiatives to improve usability for all users.
- Improved application performance, startup time, rendering efficiency, and overall user experience through optimisation and architectural improvements.
- Collaborated closely with Product Managers, Designers, QA Engineers, and Backend Engineers to deliver high-quality features from concept through production.
- Improved code quality through refactoring, reusable components, code reviews, and modern engineering best practices.
- Participated in Agile development, sprint planning, technical design discussions, and continuous product improvements.
- Helped deliver a reliable, scalable streaming experience for millions of users across multiple TV platforms and international markets.

MessageBird

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

FRONTEND ENGINEER

Aug. 2020 – Jul. 2021

- Worked in the onboarding and activation team as a React frontend engineer, balancing fast delivery with product reliability in an agile environment.
- Developed new onboarding and sign-up flows that reduced the time required for customers to connect with their users from days to minutes.
- Integrated the company design system and web-accessibility practices to deliver a consistent and inclusive customer experience.
- Participated in the support-engineer rotation, diagnosing and resolving customer problems with the wider team.

Strangelove Marketing Agency

Amsterdam, Netherlands

FRONTEND DEVELOPER

Feb. 2020 – Aug. 2020

- Developed modern e-commerce applications and introduced an API-mocking library to accelerate frontend delivery.
- Established unit and behavioural testing tools and automated invoice generation, speeding up the checkout workflow.
- Built a full-stack automated cookie-scanning, monitoring and reporting tool, removing reliance on a third-party service and securing the reporting process.

Yabbu

Amsterdam, Netherlands

FRONTEND DEVELOPER

Jul. 2019 – Jan. 2020

- Developed a cross-platform remote meeting-management product designed to reduce unnecessary meetings.
- Doubled system performance by applying frontend best practices, simplifying complex code and removing costly libraries.
- Saved approximately 10 team-hours per week by introducing two-week sprint planning, estimation and an organised Kanban workflow; also contributed to CI/CD.

UBITECH Ltd.

Athens, Greece

UI ENGINEER

Jul. 2018 – Jul. 2019

- Created the UX and visual design for a cross-platform application helping organisations such as The Smile of the Child and the Red Cross locate missing children; presented at the European Commission in 2018.
- Facilitated agile delivery in a five-person team building an IoT application that aggregated and visualised daily data streams.
- Co-developed end-to-end Schengen visa services, including a visa-request platform, legal forms and the product landing page.
- Delivered a new UX and UI for MAESTRO for DockerCon 2019 and built risk-matrix and big-data visualisations for predictive maintenance.
- Contributed to form workflows for an aviation data-value-chain platform and transformation of health records into a unified research dataset.

Human Computer Interaction Laboratory - ICS-FORTH

Heraklion, Greece

RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT ENGINEER

Jul. 2015 – Jul. 2018

- Designed and developed Ulnify, a real-time studio for composing web-application interfaces in intelligent environments, as part of an MSc thesis.
- Participated with Ulnify at the HCI International 2018 Student Design Competition in Las Vegas.
- Co-developed Beantable, an augmented interactive table with serious games for children, publicly exhibited at Vikelaia Library in 2017.
- Designed and co-developed a cross-platform monastery museum guide released on Google Play and Apple Stores.
- Co-developed an interactive information kiosk showcasing the Minoan civilization and daily life during the Minoan era, publicly exhibited at the Archaeological Museum of Crete (2016).

University of Crete

Heraklion, Greece

M.Sc. IN COMPUTER ENGINEERING – INFORMATION SYSTEMS AND HUMAN-COMPUTER INTERACTION

Mar. 2016 – Feb. 2018

- Grade: 9.23/10. Major: Information Systems and Human-Computer Interaction.
- Thesis: Ulnify: A Designer Studio for Creating UI Mashups for Ambient Intelligence Environments, presented in November 2018 under the supervision of Constantine Stephanidis.
- Teaching Assistant in Data Structures (Panagiota Fatourou) and Modern Topics in Human-Computer Interaction (Constantine Stephanidis).

University of Crete

Heraklion, Greece

B.Sc. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

Sep. 2011 – Feb. 2016

- Grade: 8.19/10. Volunteered as a teaching assistant in Computer Organisation and Introduction to Programming.
- Thesis: requirements analysis and development of a conceptual information-system model for food traceability, supervised by Irene Fundulaki and Dimitrios Plexousakis.